

MARKETING/CUSTOMER INFORMATION SYSTEMS

Second Quarter Accomplishment / Third Quarter Objectives

BUSINESS ANALYSIS

1995 Second Quarter Accomplishments

- Loaded March and April, 1995 MARLIN data into production in DataServer and MRS.
- Set up and tested MARLIN on RBM PC's locally and at Winston-Salem office. Technically ready to roll out to all RBM's.
- Modified Forsyth Products Jobber Incentive reports for Peer Account information and YTD information and added new reports and maintenance tables to support their business requirements.
- Implemented in parallel with the current production VSR system a new batch update process that involved posting CSS sales to the new VSR ADABAS file and building a new brand/geography summary process. Created 1st Quarter, 1995 Volume Ranking Reports for Trade Relations.
- Began investigation and timing of work to convert MRS to Excel 5.0, revising views where required. Currently scheduled with LAN/Server upgrade at the ROU's.
- Determined RJR scope of work and implemented extract routines and files required by IRI to support the BIAD/IRI Proposal approved to load RJR Shipment, MSA Shipment, Estimated Consumption and Annual data from ANALECT to IRI Data Server EXPRESS. Coded and tested VSR and MSA extracts that will support IRI DataServer/EXPRESS and direct VAX loads
- Evaluated the IRI Proposal for running MARLIN using IRI Bridge to Chicago database and determined it to be not cost effective.
- Implemented in MRS the following views and enhancements: a new "MARLIN Region Tracking Report"; a modified MSA Military SOM view to include RJR Savings excluding Monarch, Winston Select, Winston Base and Salem Preferred; an enhanced Competitive Offers view to remove MARLIN statistics and use advanced Excel text features; and a new Project Tracking graphical status.

MARKETING/CUSTOMER INFORMATION SYSTEMS

Second Quarter Accomplishment / Third Quarter Objectives

- Created and completed three Ad Hoc query/reports against weekly SIS Pricing Strategy data to address potential price gouging and effectiveness of implementation by Sales. Implemented Pricing Strategy Discounting matrix. Also in MRS, removed two detail Pricing strategies from MRS; modified Executive Regional Pricing Strategies to reflect presence/non-presence of Promotion Allocation dollars; added new Pricing Strategy view at Total US and Area levels to show data for only outlet/region/brand combinations receiving promotion allocation dollars; and began work on additional Pricing Strategy views for Division level data and Weekly and Monthly trended data.

BUSINESS ANALYSIS

1995 Third Quarter Objectives

- Load May, June, and July, 1995 MARLIN data into production in DataServer and MRS.
- Convert VSR on-line inquiries to new VSR ADABAS file and implement a generic VSR extraction routine, as well as VSR standard reporting; implement VSR Customer Master update and VSR shipment and customer extracts for MSA vendor. Complete Control-D Conversions for VSR, MSA, and MARLIN.
- Implement in MRS the additional Pricing Strategy views for Division level data and Weekly and Monthly trended data, as well as Executive Summary of "On Grid" only outlets. Implement Discounting Budget Status Financial report and implement revised weekly and monthly volume views. Also in MRS implement Military SOM goals with toggle button for cases/sticks view, and Top 49 Customers view with details for Full Price, Branded Savings and PL/Generic price tiers.
- Determine conversion plan for MRS with network protocol and Excel 5.0. Implementation tentatively planned for November, 1995 to coincide with ROULAN upgrades.